NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Chinatown

Boston, Massachusetts

54.3

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Grocery**

▼ Weakness: **Transit**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, Chinatown beckons with its vibrant culture, rich history, and bustling streets. This neighborhood, a fusion of the old and new, is a kaleidoscope of colors, sounds, and flavors, offering a unique blend of Asian traditions and modern urban living. Despite its moderate master score of 54.3/100, Chinatown's charm lies in its authenticity, making it a compelling choice for those seeking a dynamic and immersive cultural experience.

Chinatown is a haven for food enthusiasts, boasting an impressive array of restaurants and grocery stores. With a domain score of 78.5 for grocery and 76.6 for restaurants, it's easy to see why this neighborhood is a gastronome's paradise. From traditional Chinese bakeries to trendy fusion eateries, Chinatown caters to every palate. Ideal for young professionals, couples, and families alike, this neighborhood offers a diverse range of housing options, reflected in its housing score of 54.9. However, with a safety score of 42.9, potential residents should be aware of the neighborhood's safety concerns.

The most significant trade-off in Chinatown is its transit score of 19.0, the lowest among all domains. Despite its central location, the neighborhood's public transportation options are limited, making commuting a potential challenge. Yet, for those who value cultural immersion, culinary adventures, and the vibrancy of city life, Chinatown's strengths outweigh its weaknesses. In Chinatown, every day is an opportunity to explore, taste, and experience something new, making it a moderate pick that promises an enriching and unforgettable journey.

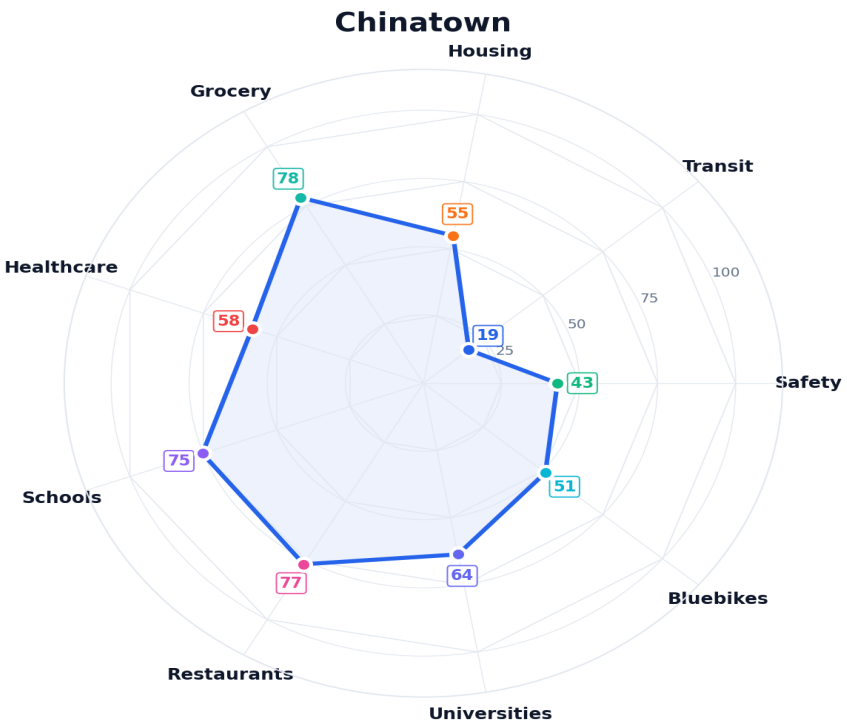
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	42.9	Moderate
Transit	19.0	Limited
Housing	54.9	Average
Grocery	78.5	Abundant
Healthcare	58.4	Good
Schools	75.3	Excellent
Restaurants	76.6	Excellent
Universities	63.7	Good

Bluebikes	51.0	Good

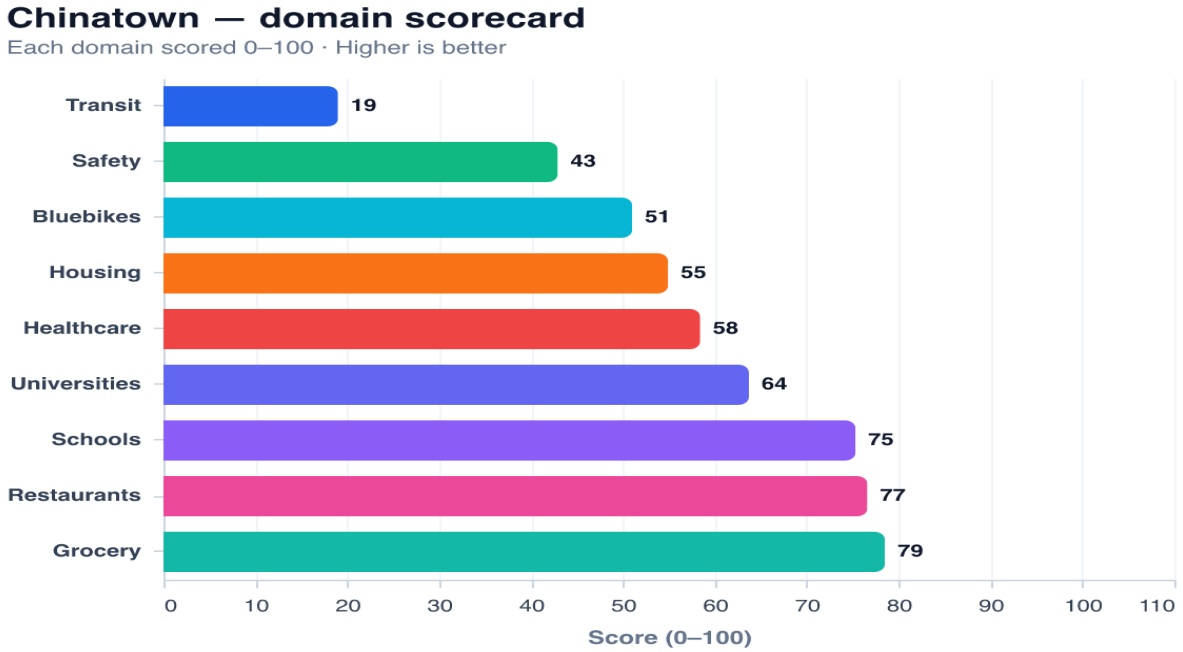
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

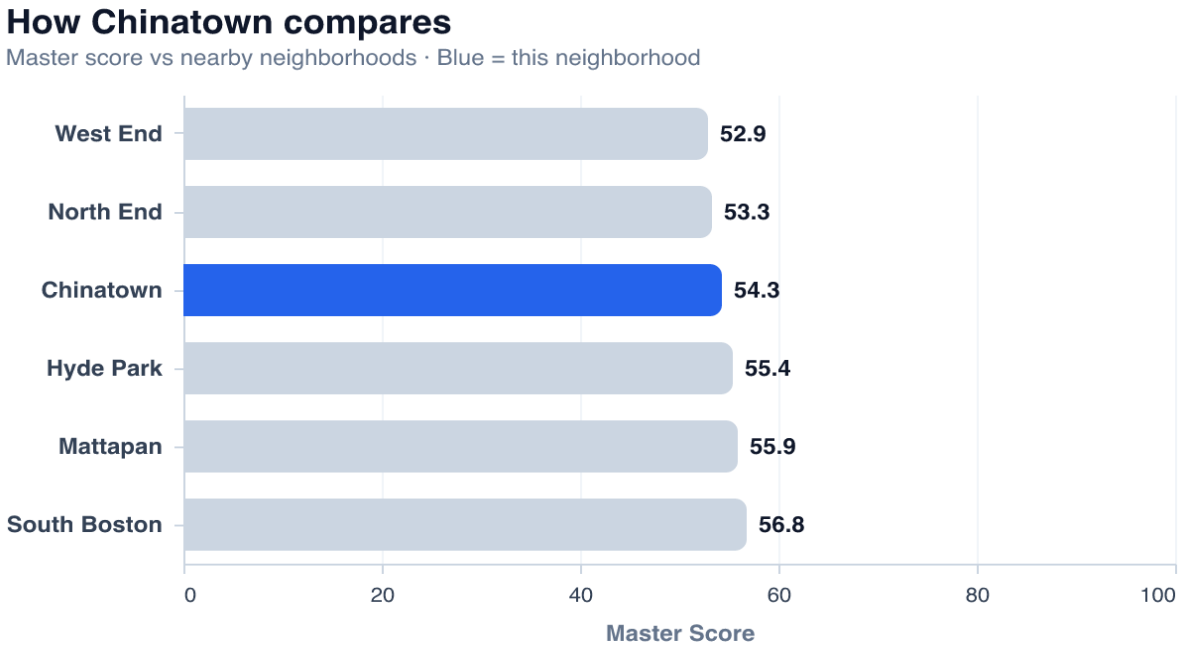
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

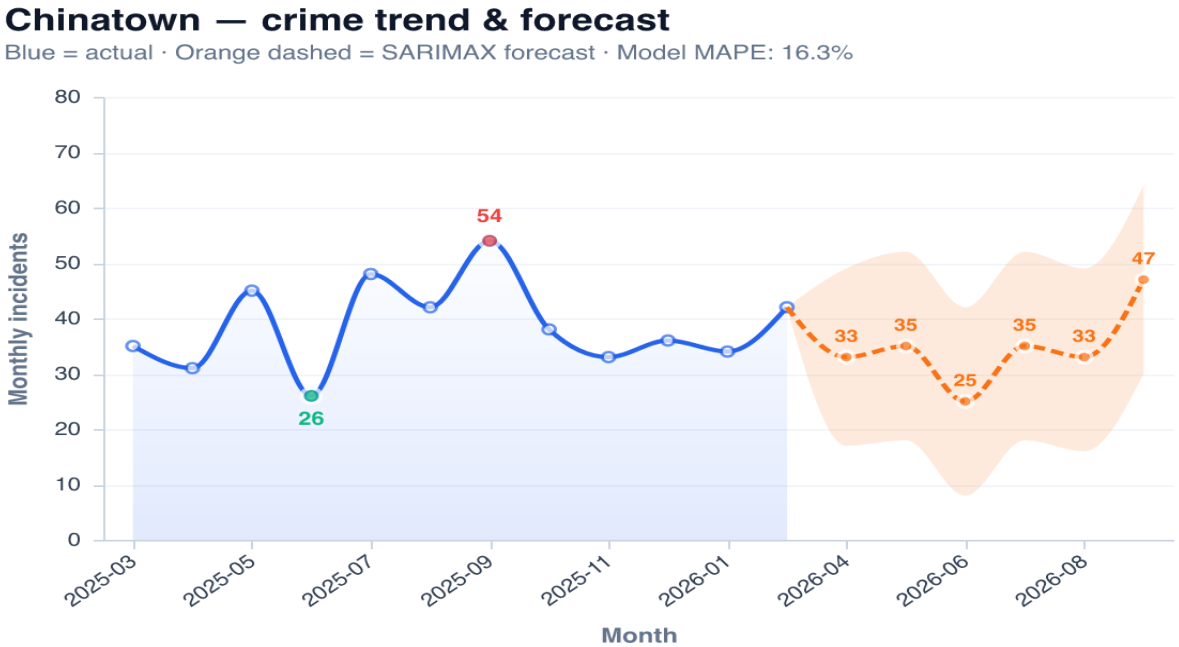
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast



Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Increasing · Model MAPE: 16.3% · Reliability: HIGH

In Boston's Chinatown, recent crime rates have seen a slight uptick, with an average of 41 monthly crimes over the past three months, compared to 34 in the same period last year. However, our forecast for April 2026 predicts a decrease to approximately 33 incidents. Notably, 96.4% of these crimes occur within three dense hotspot clusters in the neighborhood.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

● Safety

Chinatown in Boston, Massachusetts, has a moderate safety score of 42.9 out of 100, with a high density of incidents due to its small size, resulting in an inflated per-sq-mile rate of 13,516.67. The most common offense is SICK ASSIST, a police service call, while the most prevalent actual crime type is property crime, accounting for 15.60% of incidents. There has been a year-over-year increase of 6.97% in total incidents, with violent crime representing only 1.29% of the total.

● Transit

Chinatown in Boston, despite its limited transit score of 19.0 out of 100, offers a few bus routes for commuters and visitors. The area is served by the 57 bus route from Waltham Center to Federal Street & Franklin Street, the CT2 route from Nubian Station to South Station, and the 57 and 64 bus routes from Watertown Yard and Brighton Center to Federal Street & Franklin Street respectively. In total, there are 5 bus stops in the area, with all stops being wheelchair accessible. However, there are no rapid transit options directly serving Chinatown.

Restaurants

Chinatown in Boston, Massachusetts, boasts an excellent restaurant scene with a score of 76.6 out of 100, offering a dense and diverse culinary experience with approximately 5908.33 restaurants per square mile. The neighborhood's 709 establishments serve a variety of cuisines across four categories, with nearly 40% rated as high quality. The average rating of 3.8 out of 5 reflects the area's commitment to culinary excellence. Diners can choose from a mix of 220 budget, 417 mid-range, and 70 upscale eateries, with 64.5% offering delivery options.

Universities

Chinatown in Boston, Massachusetts, offers good educational access with a score of 63.7 out of 100. The neighborhood is home to one institution, Tufts University, a research university that provides a range of degree levels from bachelor's to doctorate. Notably, Tufts also offers campus housing for its students.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Chinatown in Boston, Massachusetts, is a vibrant neighborhood that has seen significant changes over the past few decades. In 1990, Asians made up 70 percent of the total population in Chinatown. From 1990 to 2010, the Asian population grew by about 950 or 20 percent. However, the White population grew by nearly 6,000 or 86 percent during the same period. This demographic shift is largely due to the introduction of a large number of luxury housing units, which increased housing and commercial rents. Despite the number of Asians in the neighborhood not declining, the influx of luxury housing has undermined the cultural and linguistic fabric of the community.

The unique character of Chinatown is at risk from gentrification and displacement, a problem not exclusive to this neighborhood but seen across other cultural communities in Boston, such as Central Americans in East Boston, the Black community in Roxbury, and the Caribbean-American community in Mattapan. Zoning has been used as a tool to create and maintain racial segregation, as highlighted in Richard Rothstein’s book 'The Color of Law'. Despite regulations being struck down by the courts, ongoing efforts to use zoning to effectively create the same results continue. This misuse of zoning has impacted the daily life in Chinatown, altering its distinctive cultural landscape and threatening the community's identity.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The Chinatown neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, seems to be most suitable for students and young professionals. The high scores in universities (63.7) and restaurants (76.6) indicate a vibrant, youthful environment with ample academic and social opportunities. The decent housing score (54.9) also suggests there are affordable living options for these demographics.

2. However, families might want to consider other neighborhoods. Despite the high score in schools (75.3), the low safety score (42.9) could be a concern for families, especially those with young children. Additionally, the low transit score (19.0) might make commuting difficult for family members with various obligations.

Data: Analyze Boston API · Cambridge Open Data · FBI Crime Data Explorer · MBTA GTFS · Snowflake Cortex · NeighbourWise RAG · Scores normalized 0–100 across 51 neighborhoods · Generated April 17, 2026 · DAMG7374